Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — conversational AI, discovery & 0-to-1

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Armenian (native, C2) · English (C1) · Russian (C2)

IN SHORT

What I bring to product is six years of discovery by necessity: sitting with people under stress, pulling out requirements they could not articulate themselves, and then rebuilding the process around what I found. Until February 2026 I owned the hardest cases at a U.S. immigration company and coordinated eight paralegals; in February 2026 I left a stable legal career to move into product properly. Since then: a U.S.-perspective project management course run by the Yerevan American Corner with the U.S. Embassy (Jul–Aug 2026), second place at HackNation and my own concept for B2B AI voice and text agents built on RAG. Conversational AI is not a box I am ticking for this application — it is what I already chose to work on.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHY THIS ROLE SPECIFICALLY

- **Conversational AI.** My own product concept is AI voice/text agents and RAG systems for B2B — vertical-specific, aimed at enterprise clients and tenders. I have spent my own time on where these interfaces break: retrieval quality, handover to a human, and what users actually type versus what you expect them to type.
- **Discovery and user research.** Client intake was my daily work for six years — structured interviews with people who describe a symptom and not the problem. That is the same muscle a product discovery call uses, and I have run it several hundred times.
- **Turning ideas into clear specs.** At M&M I rewrote the internal workflow — templates, checklists, hand-offs — and it became how the team works by default. Writing something precise enough that other people can execute it without me is the part I enjoy most.
- **Many threads at once.** 200+ live cases and 30+ hearings a week at an arbitration court, up to 12 complex filings at once, live events for up to 3,000 people. A fast-moving team will not overload me.
- **Founder-adjacent work.** I am used to being the person a principal delegates the ambiguous half of the problem to — I stood in for the team lead at Shamayev and was the escalation point at M&M.
- **Time zone.** Yerevan is UTC+4: my afternoon is your morning, so a CET/CEST team gets a solid overlap without either of us working nights.

PRODUCT & TECH TRACK

- **Own product concept, in progress** — AI voice/text agents and RAG for B2B, with separate verticals per industry.
- **HackNation** — 2nd place, local pitches; competed in the on-site final at TUMO Labs, Yerevan (July 2026).
- **42 Yerevan — Piscine**, Nov–Dec 2025. Passed selection; one month of C and peer-reviewed projects, done while holding a full-time job.
- **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Project management, U.S. perspective** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success", Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement. Earlier: PM Club, 52 hours (2023).

SKILLS

- **Product.** user interviews and discovery · writing requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · backlog grooming · roadmap input · experiment design · metric definition and tracking · competitor and market research

- **Delivery.** scope and timelines · Agile/Scrum · Gantt charts · risk tracking · SOPs and checklists people actually follow · cross-functional coordination
- **Analytical.** six years of legal analysis: reading a dense corpus, finding the one clause that decides the outcome, and defending the reasoning in writing
- **Tools.** Jira · Confluence · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Analytics · Google Workspace · basic C

EXPERIENCE

Freelance — legal & project work · PM training Feb 2026 – present

- Legal: IP assignment for works of popular musicians; corporate structure for a crypto trader; advised on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia.
- Projects: COO of the **SayWhen.am** startup (AI voice agents); business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned the most complex, highest-value cases end to end (O-1B, EB-3, E-2) — intake, strategy, evidence, submission — up to **12 running at once**.
- Coordinated **8 paralegals** on their parallel caseloads; escalation point on hard problems.
- Rewrote the internal workflow — templates, checklists, hand-offs — and it became the team default.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Shipped live events for 100–3,000 people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip.
- Ran vendors, logistics, scheduling and the day-of operation.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, sales coordination, timelines and follow-through across daily operations.

Paralegal, autonomous caseload — Bloomrich Law Firm Nov 2023 – Aug 2024

- Hired on the strength of previous results and given full ownership of how my cases were run.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. Feb 2023 – Oct 2023

- Built and ran the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training program — from curriculum to delivery; the materials went on to serve **50+ people**.
- Trusted with the firm's key cases and with standing in for the team lead.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court of the Magadan Region Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ live cases, 30+ hearings a week**, three roles at once — sustained parallel workload without losing track of a single case.

Earlier — Bar Association · LLC "SIS" (Administrator / PM) 2015 – 2021

- Contract analysis and claims work; before that 15+ construction and retail projects — teams of 2–20, contractors, procurement, tenders.

EDUCATION & OTHER

- **Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success** — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led 12 people; special assignments and a performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; humanitarian distribution to ~100 families a day.